

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437

Respondents

180+

Countries

22,677

Salary Responses

01 84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

69%

Full-time globally

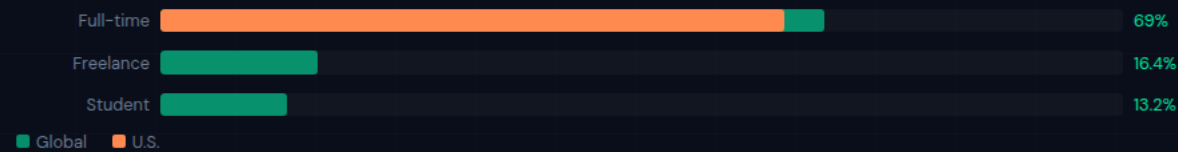
64.8%

Full-time in U.S. (↓4.2pp)

U.S. DECLINE

Full-time employment dropped from 69% (2023) to 64.8% (2024). In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time workers lean toward contracting; in Germany and India, toward students.

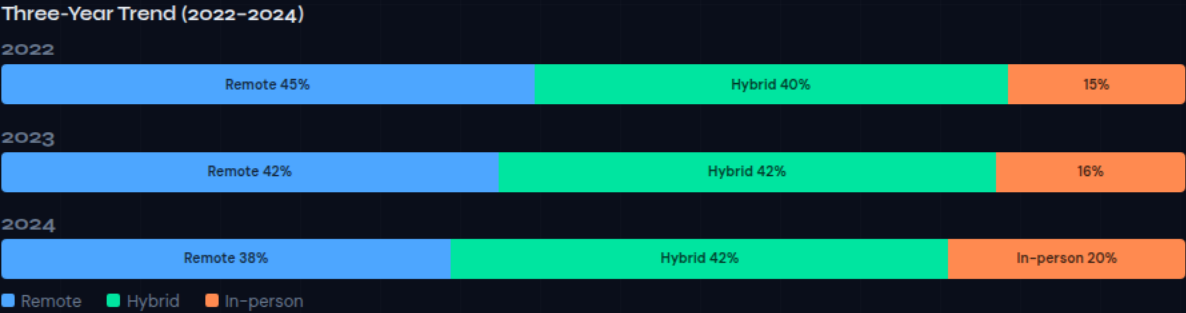
Global Employment Breakdown



02 In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



RETURN-TO-OFFICE TREND
In-person work has risen for the third consecutive year — 15% (2022) → 16% (2023) → 20% (2024).



03 Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

HIGHEST-PAID TECHNICAL ROLES

SRE (\$99K) and Cloud Infra Engineer (\$97K) are the highest-paid purely technical roles.

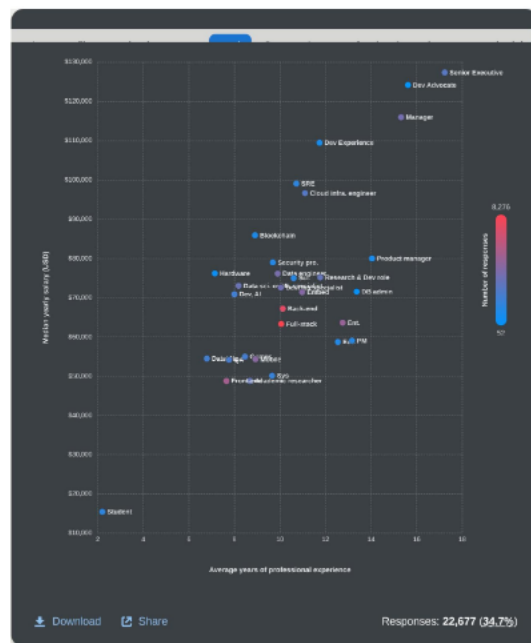
REGIONAL LEADERS

U.S.: Mobile devs · Germany/Ukraine: Data engineers · India/U.K.: Back-end devs

22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate)



04 Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



UPPER-RIGHT CLUSTER

Senior roles combine **14+ years experience** with **\$110K+ salaries**

OUTLIER

Student: **~2 years, \$15K median** — far below all professional roles

PAY-PER-YEAR RATIO

SREs earn **\$99K with ~10 years** — highest salary-to-experience ratio among technical roles

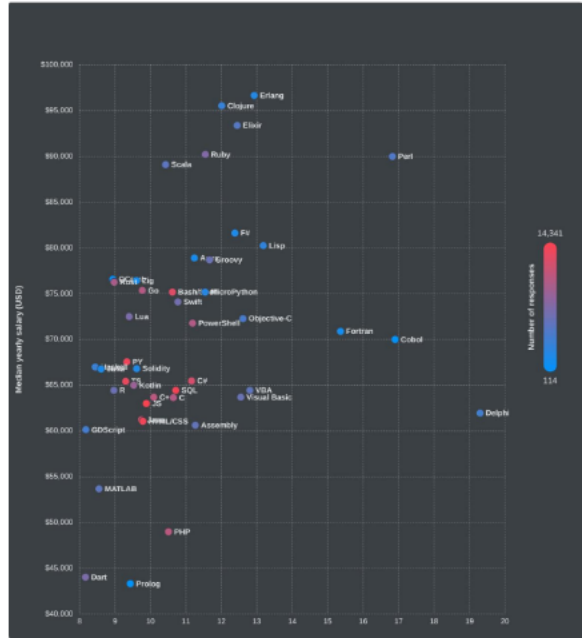
\$127K

Sr. Executive (17 yrs)

\$15K

Student (2 yrs)

05 Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



Median salary (y-axis) vs. average years of experience (x-axis) by programming language

NICHE LANGUAGES PAY PREMIUM

Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K, Elixir \$93K — functional languages dominate the top

YEAR-OVER-YEAR DECLINE

Average salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023: now \$60–75K vs. \$70–85K

MAINSTREAM VS. NICHE

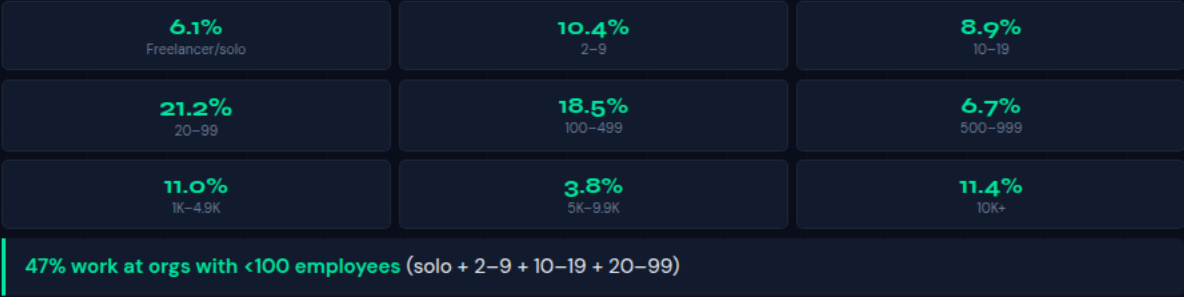
JavaScript (\$64K) and Python (\$67K) sit well below niche languages, despite broader usage

\$97K
Erlang (top language)

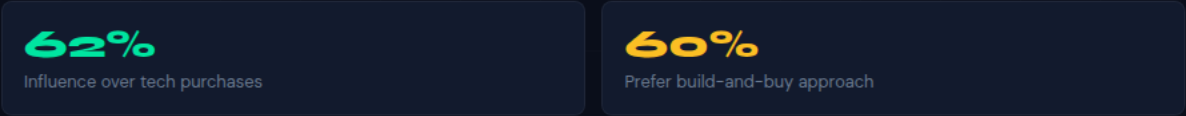
\$43K
Prolog (lowest)

06 47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

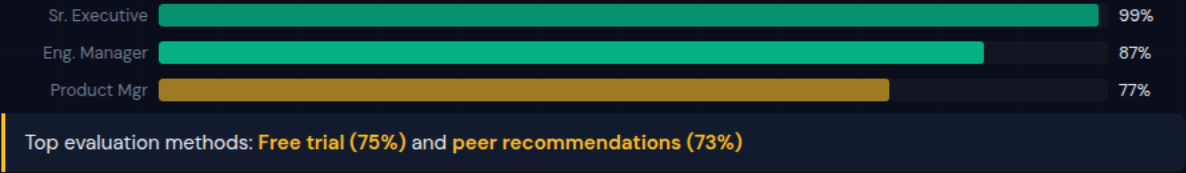
Company Size Distribution



Purchasing Influence



Influence by Role



07 Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

- 01 **Full-time employment is softening** — U.S. full-time fell 4 percentage points year-over-year; plan for more contractors and freelance talent pipelines.
- 02 **In-person mandates are growing** but hybrid (42%) still dominates — flexible work policies remain a key retention lever.
- 03 **DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay** — Sr. Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), Managers (\$116K); SREs offer the highest pay-per-experience-year ratio.
- 04 **Niche languages correlate with higher pay** — Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median; mainstream languages sit well below \$65K.
- 05 **Developers are key purchase influencers** — 62% have a say in tech buying decisions; vendor strategies should target individual contributors, not just management.